

STRATEGIC CONTEXT — THE NEXT 3 MONTHS

The next 3 months are not about broad brand awareness. They are about **building trust, proving product credibility, and converting hype into qualified waitlist and SME demand**. Marketing's role is to create the narrative, proof points, channels, and moments that help Growth build the user base — while staying within regulatory and product-readiness guardrails.

MARKETING STRATEGY

Build **trust first** (licensed bank), **hype second** (AI-native benefits made tangible), and **qualified demand third** (creators, events, PR) — to drive waitlist and SME pipeline growth while staying within regulatory guardrails.

MARKETING GOALS

1M

Waitlist Users (Global)  
*Growth owns · Mktg contributes 20%+*

500K

SME Leads Willing to Provide KYB/KYC (within 2mo of waitlist)  
*CFO Summit + Offline (Isham) + Direct Network*

1M

Social Followers  
*Benchmark Revolut · Beat WIO · LI-first*

20%+

Mktg Contribution to Growth  
*Every \$ ties to a measurable metric*

CBUAE

License (Expected Sep 2026)  
*AAS = regulator POC · Contingency Nov 1*

18

Markets at Wave 1  
*USD/ACH global · AED = UAE only*

**Next step:** Define timelines, milestones, and quarterly targets for each goal — *how will we get there?* Each figure needs an owner, a deadline, and a measurable path (e.g., 1M waitlist by when? Through which channels? At what cost per signup?).

POSITIONING — HOW WE TALK ABOUT MAL (PRIORITY ORDER)

P0 — LEAD WITH THIS

**Licensed Financial Institution**

*"Clearly a bank — a full bank with a license"*

Not a wrapper, not a prepaid card, not an EMI. Always the first thing we say.

P1 — DIFFERENTIATOR

**AI-Native Banking**

*"Open an account in 30 seconds"*

AI is not a feature. The entire bank is built on it.

P2 — TRUST LAYER / ETHICAL DIFFERENTIATION

**Islamic & Shariah-Compliant**

*"Ethical banking built in — not bolted on"*

Trust layer, not a niche. Shariah compliance earns credibility across audiences — Muslim and non-Muslim.

**Global vs UAE:** Mal (global) ≠ Mal Bank (UAE/CBUAE). AAS = POC for Public Affairs.

**Moat:** "Only moat is user-base; everything else is replicable." Must be quantitative.

**Messaging:** No generic claims. Only flex real experiences. Be quantitative or stay quiet.

CLAIM STATUS LABELS — WHAT CAN WE SAY?

| CLAIM                             | TYPE       | STATUS                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Clearly a bank — fully licensed" | Trust      | <b>Post-License</b> — for now can say "building a bank"                 |
| "Open an account in 30 seconds"   | AI speed   | <b>Product-Proof Required</b>                                           |
| "Credit limit in 30 seconds"      | AI speed   | <b>Product-Proof Required</b>                                           |
| "Never need SWIFT again"          | ACH/Global | <b>Post-License Only</b>                                                |
| "AED 300K at 5%"                  | Lending    | <b>Product-Proof Required</b>                                           |
| "4x salary"                       | Lending    | <b>Product-Proof Required</b>                                           |
| "Shariah-compliant banking"       | Trust      | <b>Needs Legal Sign-Off</b> — for now can say "built on ethical values" |
| "Mal pays your bills"             | SME        | <b>Internal Only</b>                                                    |

**Rule:** No claim goes public without product proof or license clearance. "Be quantitative or stay quiet."

AI-NATIVE — WHAT DOES IT ACTUALLY MEAN FOR THE CUSTOMER?

| AI CAPABILITY                   | CUSTOMER BENEFIT                                       |
|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Account opening in seconds      | Less friction — no paperwork, no branches              |
| Instant eligibility checks      | Faster access to financing — know in seconds, not days |
| Automated document review       | Easier SME onboarding — upload and go                  |
| Personalized financial guidance | Better decisions — AI that knows your spending         |
| AI agents (PFM, Tax, CFO)       | More useful banking — a bank that works for you        |

**Key:** Don't sell "AI." Sell the outcomes. Every AI claim must map to a tangible customer benefit.

OWNERSHIP MATRIX

BUDGET ALLOCATION

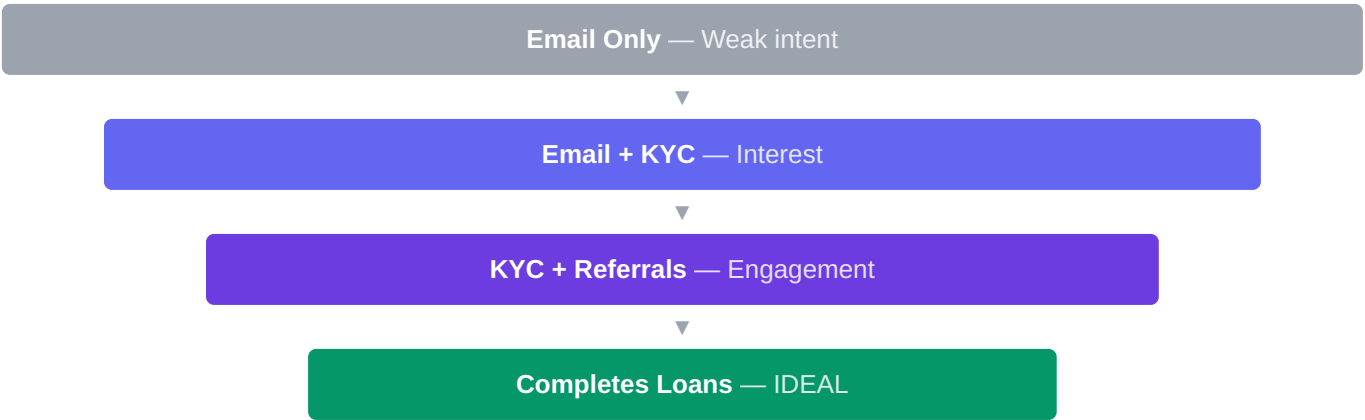


Budget: Amine · Growth strategy: Mukund · Hiring: Sama

| DOMAIN         | OWNER                 | SCOPE                                                |
|----------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Growth         | Mukund                | Userbase, retention, referral, acquisition (80%)     |
| Marketing      | Manar, Yasmeen, Isham | Brand, PR, influencers, events, social, TOV, content |
| Sales / SME    | SME Team + Isham      | Offline onboarding, CFO Summit, distribution         |
| Product        | David, VK, Manar      | Demos, tech comms, launches                          |
| Public Affairs | AAS                   | CBUAE comms (UAE-only)                               |
| Compliance     | Maen + Walid          | Risk, regulatory readiness                           |
| Hiring         | Sama                  | Marketing team hiring plan                           |
| Budgets        | Amine                 | Budget allocation & approval                         |

Rule: Mktg does NOT own growth metrics but must contribute 20%+. Referral program owned by Growth.

WAITLIST FUNNEL & GUARDRAILS



KYC may not be live at waitlist launch. Without KYC, the funnel is hype + referral only — this means we will attract a high volume of **window shoppers** (email-only signups). **That's OK — volume drives the 1M waitlist goal.** Focus positioning on: licensed bank, AI-native, Shariah-compliant. Convert window shoppers into adopters once KYC goes live.

| GUARDRAIL             | RATIONALE                           |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Clients ≠ Partners    | Closes doors (ADNOC = client)       |
| No generic claims     | Be quantitative or stay quiet       |
| Mal ≠ Mal Bank        | CBUAE only cares about UAE          |
| Only real experiences | "2 seconds" not "we're fast"        |
| 90% revenue = lending | Banking acquires, lending generates |

INCENTIVE STRATEGY BY SEGMENT

| SEGMENT                                                                                                                        | HOOK                                     | INCENTIVE                                  | PRODUCT ANGLE                                | CHANNEL               |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| Window Shoppers                                                                                                                | "Join waitlist, get paid"                | Cash for signup; share LI/IG/X → \$X       | Waitlist virality                            | Social, Paid LI       |
| Adopters                                                                                                                       | "Try the tech first"                     | Founder Card + 1-yr sub + beta + community | UI, speed, process                           | LI Thought Leaders    |
| Retail                                                                                                                         | "Never need SWIFT again"                 | Global Accounts first (USD/ACH); 4x salary | Expats EG/TR/IN/PK; lending later (Wave 2–3) | Partnerships, Digital |
| SMEs                                                                                                                           | "Upload paperwork — eligible in seconds" | AED 300K at 5%; Mal pays your bills        | Bank + Lender one-stop                       | CFO Summit, Offline   |
| Competitive Stack: FAB = large SMEs, no lending. WIO = tiny SMEs. EFG = lender not bank. <b>Mal = Bank + Lender. One-stop.</b> |                                          |                                            |                                              |                       |

WAITLIST HYPE PLAYBOOK

- 10-20 influencers (LI primary, explore IG/X/other platforms)
- Isham identifies influencers & groups per platform with 3rd-party agency
- "UI is great, credit limit in 30 seconds"
- CTA: "I just joined the Mal waitlist and I have 5 slots to give"
- Share to LI/IG/X → get \$X free (package TBD)
- Benchmarks: Revolut, Clubhouse waitlist models

5 Hype Pillars

- UI excellence
- Authentically Islamic
- Product speed
- Referral + Founder Card
- Private community

CFO SUMMIT & LAUNCH EVENT

CFO Summit

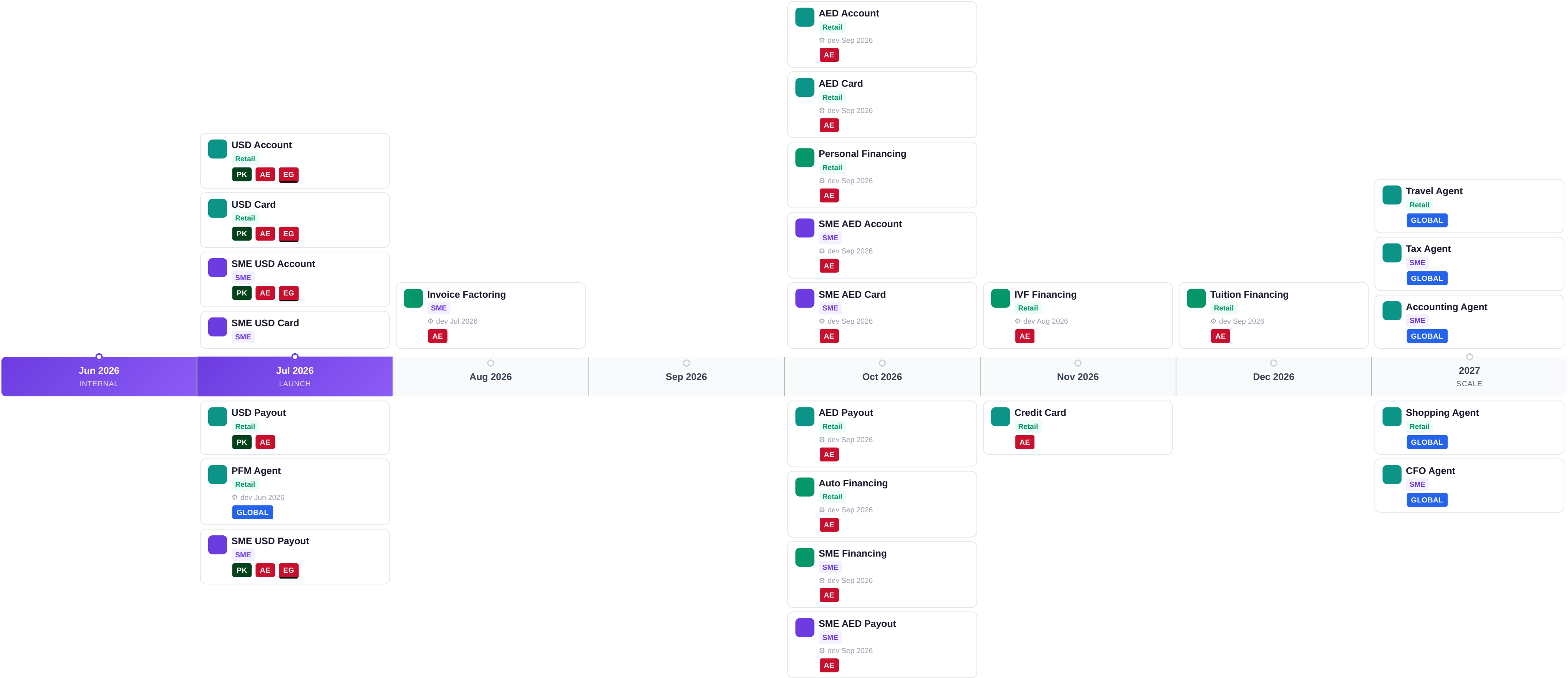
This is not an awareness event. It is a **high-intent SME pipeline and credibility engine**. Success = qualified SME leads, demos booked, pain points captured, and follow-up pipeline created.

- Top CFOs in ME, 50 max, private round table
- 2-3 VIP speakers (e.g., Hazem)
- "Where are you facing issues with your existing bank?"
- Capture: company info, employees, distribution
- "Mal pays your bills — onboard your vendors"

Media Training

- Amine
- David
- VK
- Zigor
- Maen+Walid
- Youssef

2nd line: Talga, Rideu, Izz





MARKETING ROADMAP — PHASES, LICENSING & EVENTS

|                    | Jun 2026<br>NOW                                                     | Jul 2026<br>NEXT                                                                                                                | Aug 2026                                                                  | Sep 2026                                         | Oct 2026                                                     | Nov–Dec 2026                                               | 2027 |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| MARKETING PHASES   | Phase 1: Plumbing<br>Internal QA, stress testing, no external comms | Phase 2: Waitlist Hype (Pre-Launch)<br>5 Hype Pillars · 20-30 influencers (LI, IG/X) · Isham + agency · Referral + Founder Card |                                                                           |                                                  | Grand Launch<br>Oct 10 (contingency Nov 11)                  | Scale · Paid acquisition · Lending comms                   |      |
| LAUNCH COMMS       |                                                                     | ACH Launch Comms (Wave 1) GLOBAL<br>"Never need SWIFT again" · Target: EG Egypt · TR Turkey · IN India · PK Pakistan expats     |                                                                           |                                                  | AED Launch Comms (Wave 2)<br>AE UAE · Post-license messaging | Lending product comms (IVF, Tuition, Credit Card) · AE UAE |      |
| LICENSING & EVENTS |                                                                     |                                                                                                                                 | CFO Summit<br>50 pax · Top CFOs in ME · Private round table · TBD Aug–Dec | CBUAE License<br>AE Expected. If delayed → Nov 1 | Launch Event<br>Oct 10 or Nov 11                             |                                                            |      |

| IMMEDIATE ACTION ITEMS |                                  |                                                                           |          |              |
|------------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|--------------|
| #                      | OWNER(S)                         | ACTION                                                                    | PRIORITY | STATUS       |
| 1                      | AAS + Walid                      | Roadmap + product suite sign-off, share with team                         | URGENT   | FINAL STAGES |
| 2                      | Manar + Yasmeen + Isham          | Brainstorm marketing and incentive strategy, PR strategy, branding        | URGENT   | PENDING      |
| 3                      | Manar + Yasmeen + Isham          | Brainstorm CFO Summit + Launch Event (Oct 10 / contingency Nov 11)        | URGENT   | PENDING      |
| 4                      | Manar                            | Budget allocations: marketing, brand, sales, growth (Amine approves)      | HIGH     | PENDING      |
| 5                      | Yasmeen + Walid                  | Schedule calls between Manar and GA team vs other product leads           | HIGH     | IN PROGRESS  |
| 6                      | Isham (lead) + Yasmeen (content) | Define waitlist referral package (share to LI/IG/X → \$X reward)          | HIGH     | PENDING      |
| 7                      | Isham + 3rd-party agency         | Identify 10-20 influencers & groups per platform for paid hype            | HIGH     | PENDING      |
| 8                      | Marketing Team                   | Get to 1M waitlist users (incentive + ACH/USD — excl. sanctioned markets) | HIGH     | PENDING      |
| 9                      | Marketing Team                   | Internal corporate comms + assets (brand DNA, gifting, decks, attire)     | MEDIUM   | PENDING      |
| 10                     | Mukund                           | Growth budget request strategy (Amine = budget holder)                    | MEDIUM   | PENDING      |
| 11                     | Sama / Amine                     | Hiring plan for marketing team (Sama = hiring, Amine = budget)            | MEDIUM   | PENDING      |

|                                                                                                                                                                 |                                    |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| CRITICAL PATH                                                                                                                                                   | 25 products · 4 waves · 18 markets |
| Plumbing (Jun) → Waitlist Hype → Wave 1 USD (Jul) → Invoice Factoring (Aug) → License (Sep) → Launch Event + Wave 2 (Oct) → Wave 3 (Nov–Dec) → AI Agents (2027) | Confidential · Internal use only   |